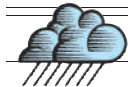


Derik Queen’s buzzer-beater sends the Maryland men to the Sweet 16. D1

The Washington Post

Prices may vary in areas outside metropolitan Washington.

SU V1 V2 V3 V4



Morning rain 66/48 • Tomorrow: Partly sunny 64/42 B6

Democracy Dies in Darkness

MONDAY, MARCH 24, 2025 • \$4

Europe reevaluates U.S. arms dependence

Trump’s unpredictability spurs allies to expand homegrown production

BY ELLEN FRANCIS, MISSY RYAN AND MICHAEL BIRNBAUM

BRUSSELS — As President Donald Trump upends U.S. foreign policy, negotiating closer relations with Russia, threatening NATO allies and pausing cooperation with Ukraine, Washington’s traditional partners — and best customers — are rethinking their dependence on American weapons systems.

From Canada to Europe, calls are growing to steer future defense spending away from U.S. equipment and toward their own industries, even as many concede there’s no quick fix after decades of dependence.

The U.S. pause of intelligence-sharing with Ukraine this month, and Trump’s threats to annex Canada and Greenland, have laid bare the risks of counting on the United States — and raised concerns about whether Washington could ground jets or turn off launchers remotely as a pressure tactic.

Even if such a “kill switch” is a myth, officials and analysts say, advanced U.S. systems such as fighter jets are so reliant on U.S. spare parts, software updates or data sharing that cutting access could effectively render some

SEE EUROPE ON A8



CIRO DE LUCA/REUTERS



DOMENICO STINELLIS/AP

Weakened but waving, pope departs hospital

After five weeks of treatment for double pneumonia, Pope Francis left a hospital in Rome on Sunday. In St. Peter’s Square at the Vatican, above, crowds watched his appearance on a big screen. He headed to Vatican City, where doctors say the 88-year-old pontiff will continue treatment during a period of rest. **Story, A10**

Israel plans for widened Gaza war

REPORTED DEATH TOLL PASSES 50,000

New incursion could lead to occupation for months

BY GERRY SHIH

JERUSALEM — As Israel’s forces push back into Gaza after a two-month ceasefire with Hamas, its political and military leaders are considering plans for a fresh ground campaign that could include a military occupation of the entire enclave for months or more.

The new and more aggressive tactics, according to current and former Israeli officials and others briefed, will probably also include direct military control of humanitarian aid; targeting more of Hamas’s civilian leadership; and evacuating women, children and vetted noncombatants from neighborhoods to “humanitarian bubbles” and laying siege to those who remain — a more intense version of a tactic employed last year in northern Gaza.

Israeli officials say they are still waiting for the outcome of ceasefire talks and that no decisions have been made on whether — and how — to escalate the current phase of the offensive, which has so far consisted of mostly aerial bombardment.

But if the maximalist tactics SEE ISRAEL ON A9

Meta’s scramble to silence tell-all raises its sales volume

BY NAOMI NIX

Sarah Wynn-Williams was preparing for a television appearance one evening last week when the news popped on social media: Meta had won an arbitration case banning her from promoting her tell-all memoir about her years working for the social media company. No need to get up at 5 a.m. for the interview — the segment was spiked.

On the basis of a non-disparagement agreement Wynn-Williams signed when she was fired by Meta in 2017, the independent arbiter ruled that the former company executive cannot grant any of the nearly 100 interview

requests she has received from journalists from print and broadcast news outlets in the United States and the United Kingdom, according to a person familiar with the matter, who spoke on the condition of anonymity to avoid legal issues. The order also bars her from talking with lawmakers in the U.S., London and the European Union, according to a legal challenge she lodged against the ruling.

Meta’s legal action is the company’s latest move in a weeks-long campaign to undercut Wynn-Williams, a former global policy director for the company, and her 400-page memoir, “Careless Peo-

SEE META ON A14

Citing Trump’s example, autocrats roll back rights

BY ANTHONY FAIOLA

Under Hungary’s antigay “propaganda” law, bookstores were fined for selling LGBTQ+ themed tomes without sealed plastic wrappers and a museum director was fired for allowing minors into an exhibit with images of same-sex couples. But the autocratic government of Prime Minister Viktor Orban stopped short of targeting the community’s pre-

mier event: the annual Pride parade.

Until now. Parliament voted overwhelmingly this month to ban the event — and threatened to use facial recognition technology to identify violators.

What changed? According to Orban, it was the return to the White House of President Donald Trump.

Gergely Gulyas, Orban’s chief of staff, told journalists that the

change in administrations in Washington had lifted the “American boot” off the chest of the Hungarian government, making it easier “to breathe.”

Orban himself noted that the Biden administration’s ambassador to Hungary — David Pressman, a fierce Orban critic who directly challenged the nationalist leader’s democratic backsliding — made a point of participating in Budapest Pride, an event

that has brought 35,000 people to the Hungarian capital, to protect it.

Pride “shouldn’t have existed earlier, but it did, because the U.S. ambassador led the march, which clearly showed that the world’s great powers supported it,” Orban said last month. “But now the world has changed, and the Americans have called these types of ambassadors back home.

SEE TRUMP ON A2

Constituents hunt for answers from GOP congressman

Rep. Dale W. Strong faces backlash to DOGE cutbacks in a district awash with federal money

BY DANIELLE PAQUETTE



MICHAEL S. WILLIAMSON/THE WASHINGTON POST

Melanie Kolowski held a silent protest with Zeb Lemon, left, and Jeremy Devito as Rep. Dale W. Strong (R-Alabama) spoke at the defense contractor event. Strong has avoided speaking to constituents.

HUNTSVILLE, ALA. — She didn’t want to be dismissed as a left-wing liberal, so Melanie Kolowski slipped on a floral sundress, jean jacket and four-inch wedges before heading to her congressman’s church.

Rep. Dale W. Strong (R) had been attending Mt. Zion Baptist since boyhood, according to his website, so Kolowski, the daughter of a Southern Baptist preacher, figured this Sunday service was her best chance to find him.

The 45-year-old portrait photographer had questions, she said, and the man meant to represent her hadn’t answered her calls, emails or postcards. Nor had he agreed to schedule an in-person town hall here since outrage soared over Elon Musk’s chainsaw approach to government downsizing, citing risk of disruption from what he called “left-wing liberals.”

SEE ALABAMA ON A4

A Chinatown mainstay may be on its last legs

BY PAUL SCHWARTZMAN

The rows of framed photographs on the wall are remnants of a faded Washington, when mayors and congressmen and presidents, hungry for crispy wontons and maybe a serving of spare ribs or jumbo shrimp, invariably found their way to Tony Cheng’s in Chinatown.

At lunchtime on a recent day, the restaurant’s 160-seat dining room was empty except for Cheng, his wife, Julie, a water tank populated by five lobsters, and all those ghostly grip-and-grin photos — Tony and Mayor Marion Barry, Tony and Anthony Williams, Tony and Jimmy Carter.

The phone rang. The phone rang again and again.

The Chengs made no move. “I don’t want to answer,” Julie Cheng said. “Everyone wants to know, ‘When are you open?’ I don’t know what to say.”

The D.C. government shut down Tony Cheng’s late last month, slapping several red-lettered “SUSPENDED” notices across the entrance. D.C. officials, in a court filing, say the restaurant owes the city more than \$500,000 in back taxes, a debt the Chengs acknowledge they must pay if they hope to reopen.

A faltering restaurant is hardly remarkable in an industry where

SEE TONY CHENG’S ON A14

IN THE NEWS

Snap election in Canada Prime Minister Mark Carney requested an April vote, seeking to capitalize on his party’s momentum in the face of President Donald Trump’s threats. A6

Wisconsin high court Trump and Elon Musk have ramped up their involvement in a race with implications for abortion rights. A3

THE NATION
Second lady Usha Vance will visit Greenland this week with a U.S. delegation. A2
A U.S. appellate judge brought out a bag of firearms in an unusual dissent video. A3

A poll finds what Americans would accept in a Ukraine peace deal. A5

THE WORLD
In a test for green policies, Parisians cast ballots on whether to make 500 streets car-free. A7

THE ECONOMY
Proposed fees on Chinese container ships, part of a strategy to revive U.S. shipbuilding, could bring about supply chain disruptions. A11

THE REGION
Federal workers are sharply divided over a return-to-office mandate, a poll finds. B1

Maryland may combine algebra and geometry courses for older students as part of a broader effort to improve performance in math. B1
The ongoing redevelopment of Barry Farm in Southeast Washington includes the city’s biggest geothermal installation. B1

STYLE
We may never know how many priceless works in private hands went up in smoke in the Los Angeles fires, raising questions about the economics of the art world amid a climate crisis. C1
A big-ticket revival of “Othello” seems like a big overinvestment. C1

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